COLLEGE DE PARIS SUPERIEUR

Welcome to Business English 1

Bachelor 1 – English for IT Professionals



Dorcas Tchogoue

"The Mysterious Email"

Meet Leo …



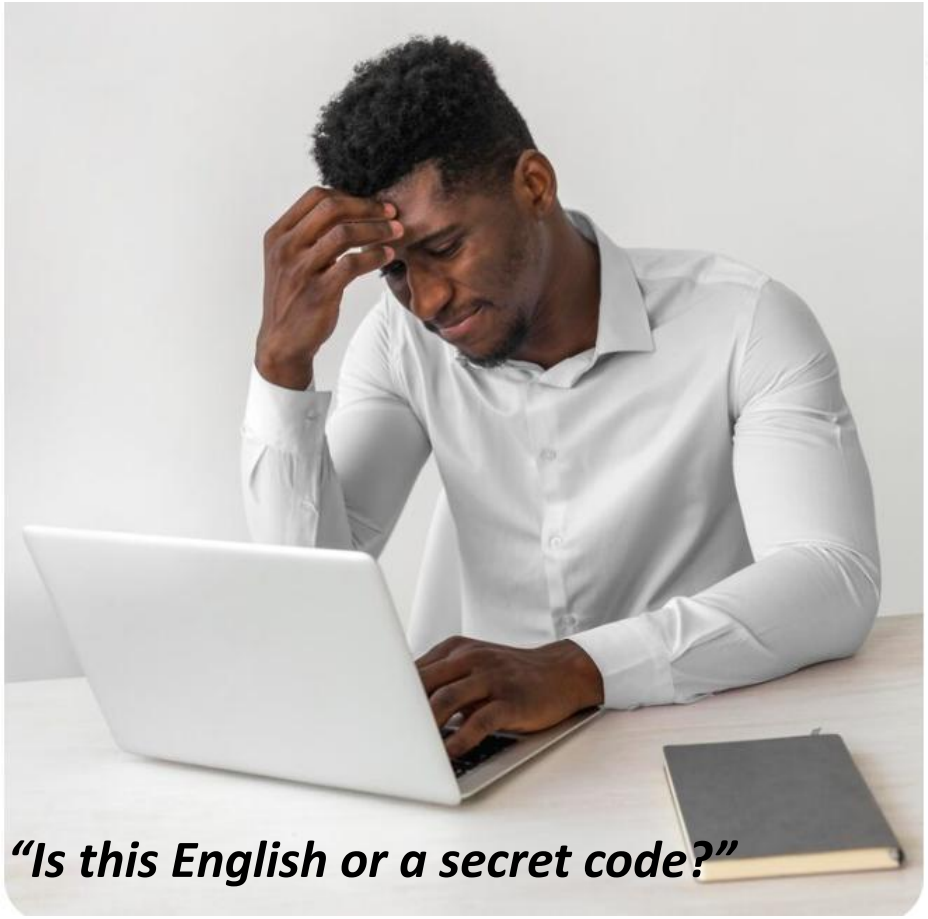
“Leo – the Tanaka project has a hard deadline on Friday. Please touch base with Zoe about the budget and stakeholders. I need you to get the ball rolling by tomorrow. Attached – the low-hanging fruit list. Don’t forget to reply all to the team.”



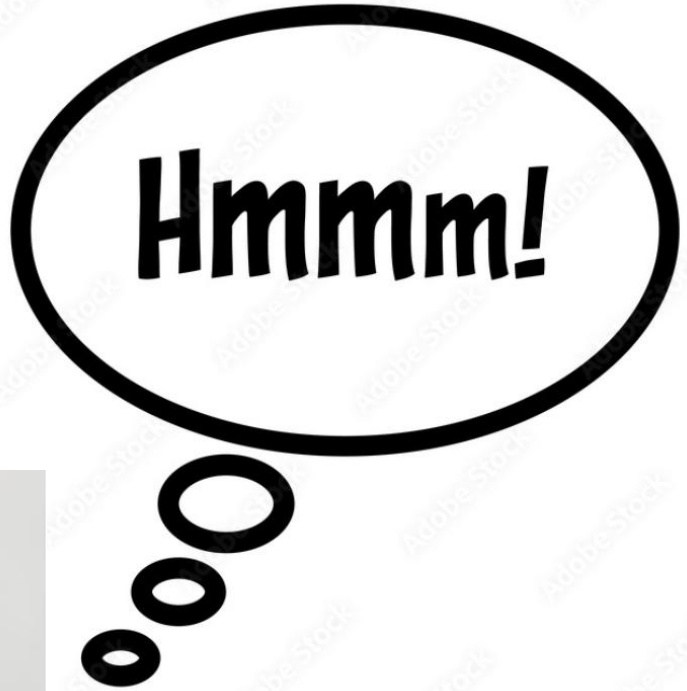
Touch base?

Hard deadline?

Low-hanging fruit?



“Is this English or a secret code?”



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Session 1: Business Vocabulary Basics

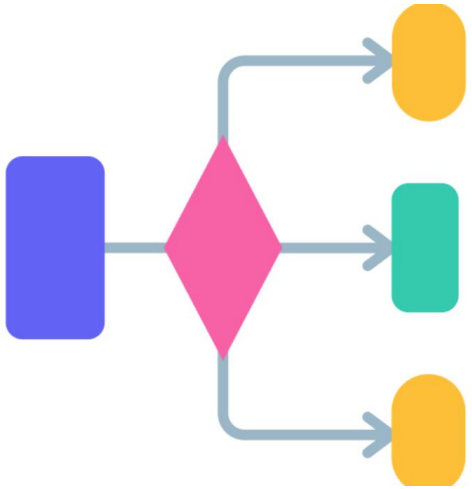


SESSION 1: Business Vocabulary Basics

Objectives:

- ❖ Identify and use 15+ core business vocabulary words in spoken and written contexts.
- ❖ Distinguish between casual and professional language.
- ❖ Recognize and correct common French–English false friends.
- ❖ Apply 3–4 business expressions in workplace scenarios.
- ❖ Collaborate in team activities to reinforce vocabulary retention.
- ❖ Demonstrate understanding of email-related vocabulary.

Goals



1) Learners actively use target vocabulary in speaking, writing, listening, and games.
2) Learners leave with a personalized mini-glossary.
3) Learners feel engaged and laugh – reducing anxiety around professional English.

Why Business English for IT?

- You'll need emails, meetings, presentations with clients/managers/stakeholders

Mini exercise:

"What's one business situation where you'll speak English?"

(Pair discussion – 2 min)



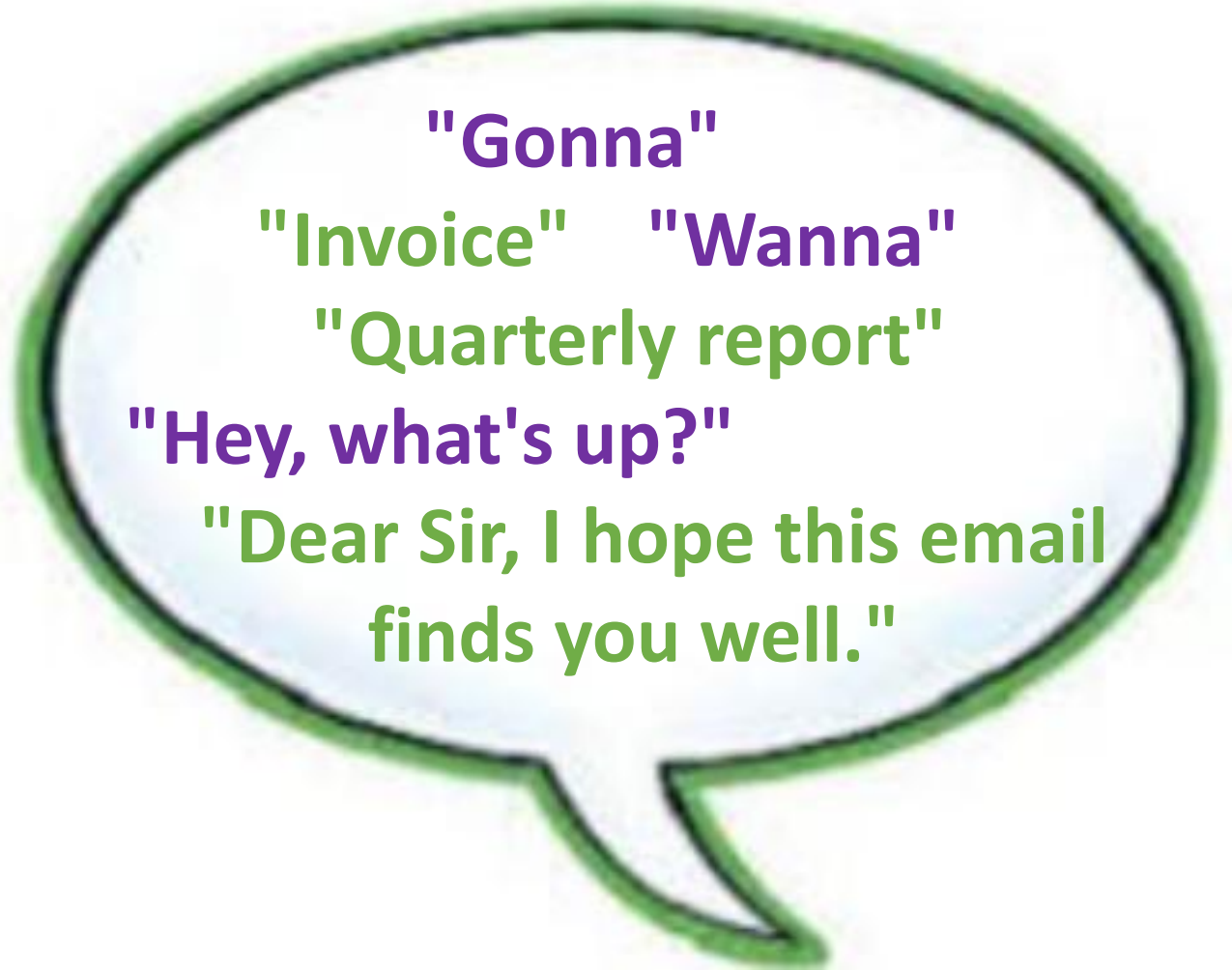
Warm-up: Business or Not?

Class vote: Is this word /phrase for business or casual?



Warm-up: Business or Not?

Class vote: Is this word /phrase for business or casual?



Key Business Vocabulary – Set 1 (General)

Exercise: Match words to definitions

TERMS	DEFINITIONS
Deadline	available/planned money
Stakeholder	person interested in the project
Budget	final date to finish work





Client (long-term relationship) ≠ customer

Key Business Vocabulary – Set 1 (General)

TERMS	DEFINITIONS
Deadline	final date to finish work
Stakeholder	person interested in the project
Budget	available/planned money





Client (long-term relationship) ≠ customer

IT - Specific Business Vocabulary
Group work

- Write one sentence using a word from this list

Example: "The deployment is scheduled for Friday."

- Deployment
- Backend / Frontend
- Sprint (Agile methodology)
- UAT (User Acceptance Testing)



Term	Simple meaning	Example sentence
Deployment	Releasing software so people can use it	"The deployment is Friday at 10 PM."
Backend	The invisible part that makes things work (servers, databases)	"The backend team fixed the database."
Frontend	What users see and click (buttons, menus, design)	"The frontend developer changed the button color."
Sprint	A short work period (1–4 weeks) to finish specific tasks	"We will add a search bar this sprint."
UAT	Final testing where real users try the software	"The client approved the software after UAT."

Vocabulary Quiz – Team Challenge

1: Long-term paying person?

2: Short work period in Agile?

3: UAT means?

4: Budget = money ___?

5: Is "deadline" a happy word?



Vocabulary Quiz – Team Challenge

ANSWERS

1: Long-term paying person? → Client
2: Short work period in Agile? → Sprint
3: UAT means? → User Acceptance Testing
4: Budget = money ___? → available/planned
5: Is "deadline" a happy word? → No (stressful!)



Common Mistakes – False Friends (French→English)



Exercise: Is "Actually, I am in a meeting" correct?
"I work in a library" means you sell books!

- Actually ≠ actuellement *(Actually = en fait)*
- Eventually ≠ éventuellement *(Eventually = finalement)*
- Library ≠ librairie *(Library = bibliothèque)*

Group Activity – Vocabulary Race

Each team gets 3 business situations
Examples: "project delay", "new client", "small budget"

- Write 5 relevant business words in 3 minutes

Example for "delay":
deadline, stakeholder, report, update, meeting



Group Activity – Vocabulary Race

Business situations:

New Client

Client, Stakeholder, Proposal, Meeting, Contract

One sentence sum:
"In the meeting with the new client, present the proposal so all stakeholders can review the contract."

Small Budget

Budget, Low-hanging fruit, Deadline, Resource, Priority

Business Expressions – Useful & Funny

Exercise: Replace simple words with expressions:

"Touch base" = ... easy wins
"Get the ball rolling" = ... contact briefly
"Low-hanging fruit" = ... start

"Let's start" → "Let's get the ball rolling"
"I'll contact you" → "I'll touch base"



Funny Roleplay – Bad Business English



In pairs:

- Person A uses very bad English
- Person B tries to understand

Debrief: What words were missing?

Example: "Me want finish work soon yes"

Bad Business English	CORRECTION
"Me want finish work soon yes"	
Polite request → *"You send file yesterday?"*	
"Project delay. Client angry. What do?"	
"Meeting tomorrow. You come?"	
"Budget no money. Problem big."	
"Deadline Friday. Work weekend?"	
Polite question → *"Server crash. Fix now!"*	
"Client call. You talk. Not me."	***Polite refusal*** →

Bad Business English	CORRECTION
"Me want finish work soon yes"	*"I want to finish work soon."*
Polite request → *"You send file yesterday?"*	*"Did you send the file yesterday?"*
"Project delay. Client angry. What do?"	*"The project is delayed. The client is angry. What should we do?"*
"Meeting tomorrow. You come?"	*"There is a meeting tomorrow. Can you come?"*
"Budget no money. Problem big."	*"There is no money in the budget. This is a big problem."*
"Deadline Friday. Work weekend?"	*"The deadline is Friday. Do we have to work on the weekend?"*
Polite question → *"Server crash. Fix now!"*	*"The server crashed. Could we please fix it now?"*
"Client call. You talk. Not me."	***Polite refusal*** → *"The client is calling. Can you talk to them? I cannot."*

Business Vocabulary in Emails – Preview

Common email words: Attached, Forward, Reply all
Warning: Reply all disasters are real!

Exercise:
What happens if you reply all by mistake?

Share a short funny story



Fill-in-the-blanks – Business Sentences

- Please find the report _____
- The _____ for the task is Friday.
- We need to _____ base next week.

Shout out your answers!



Fill-in-the-blanks – Business Sentences

- Please find the report **attached.**

- The **deadline** for the task is Friday.

- We need to **touch** base next week.



Listening & Vocab – Audio Script

Exercise: Write down 5 business words you hear



Listening & Vocab – Audio Script

Exercise: Write down 5 business words you hear

"Dear team, the sprint deadline is Friday. Please update the budget and attach the UAT results. Let's touch base tomorrow."



Answers:

sprint, deadline, budget, attach, UAT, touch base.

Funny Activity – Business Word Taboo

One student describes a business word without saying it. Class guesses.

Example word:"deadline" – cannot say "date, final, finish, time"



Vocabulary for Meetings – Useful Phrases

- "Let's circle back to that" = discuss later
- "I'll take action on that" = I will do it
- "Could you elaborate?" = please explain more

Exercise:

A: "The server crashed."

B: "Could you elaborate?"

(When? Why?)



Workplace Scenario:
Apply business expressions

Team Challenge – Build a Mini-Glossary

Each team creates a 10-word business glossary for IT professionals

Group work



Mini-Glossary for IT Professionals

1. Client = Long-term customer
2. Customer = One-time or occasional buyer
3. Deadline = Final date to finish work
4. Stakeholder = Person who cares about the project
5. Budget = Available money
6. Invoice = Bill for services or products
7. Deployment = Releasing software
8. Sprint = Short work period (Agile)
9. UAT = User Acceptance Testing
10. Backend = Invisible part (servers, databases)
11. Frontend = What users see and click
12. Touch base = Contact someone briefly
13. Get the ball rolling = Start something
14. Low-hanging fruit = Easy wins
15. Circle back = Discuss later

Review and Reflection

- What have you learned today?
- Share one thing you learned and how you will apply it





Homework

1. Find 5 business English words from an English IT website (e.g., Stack Overflow, LinkedIn job offer). Write them + definition.

2. Write 3 funny sentences using business vocabulary. *(e.g., "My cat missed the deadline for catching the mouse")*

3. Prepare to share one new word next session.



Instruction: To be completed in your notebook before next class.
Note: This work is compulsory.
Students without completed homework at the start of class will receive a 2-mark deduction.

Preview of Session 2 . . .

Next Time: Professional Email Writing

- Learn the structure of a professional email.
- Use today's words to write realistic IT work emails.
- Analyze good vs. bad email examples.
- Complete a writing workshop with peer review.



Some valuable resources:

Recommended Book

Title: Business Vocabulary in Use – Intermediate (Cambridge University Press)
Authors: Bill Mascull
Relevant unit: Units 1–5 (Work and jobs, Business communication, IT in business)
Why: Clear, IT-friendly examples, exercises with answers. Perfect for Bachelor 1 level.

Lighter Reading

Title: “25 Business English expressions you need to know” (Article)
Source: FluentU / Business English Resources (free online)
Why: Short, funny examples. Students can find 5 expressions they like.
Bonus for IT focus
Blog: The IT English Blog (by Jeremy Walsh – free)
Why: Vocabulary for developers, Scrum, Agile, client meetings.

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Thank you!



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